

7.4

Dealing with questions

Worksheet

- A** Match each 'problem person' with one or more techniques. What else could you do?

Problem Person

Somebody who ...

- 1 ... whispers during your talk.
- 2 ... interrupts with an irrelevant question.
- 3 ... challenges you on a factual point.
- 4 ... asks a difficult question at the end.

Techniques

- a Redirect the question back to the questioner.
- b Thank them and ask the group to comment.
- c Say they might be right and you will check later.
- d Say you'll deal with that point later.
- e Ignore them.

- B** Think of a situation when you would use each technique below.

- 1 Redirect to the questioner
- 2 Redirect to the group
- 3 Redirect to another person

- C** Complete the table with the five techniques in the box.

Redirect to another person Redirect to the questioner
Redirect to the group Clarify Control the timing

1 _____	Let me check I understand. Are you asking ...? Well, it all depends what you mean by ... Could you be a little more specific?
2 _____	That's a very interesting question. Could I ask you what your own view is? You must have thought quite a lot about this. What do you think?
3 _____	Anyone like to comment on that? Has anyone else had a similar problem?
4 _____	That's a good question, but I'm afraid it's not really my field. Mr. Hamad, can you help me to answer that? Asif, I think you know more about this.
5 _____	OK, we only have a few minutes left. Is there one last question? I'm afraid that's all we have time for. Thank you all very much for your attention.

- D** Choose a topic from the list below. Alternatively, choose one of your own. Give a very short presentation. Invite and deal with questions at the end.

- A future political/social problem in my country.
- Business and the environment.
- Doing business with people from other cultures.
- Join the New Age Foundation! Give us 10% of your salary and find inner peace.
- Give me \$100! I'll turn it into \$200 and we'll split the profit.

Audience questions

What exactly did you mean when you were talking about ...

I was interested in your comments about ... Could you say a little more about that?

Could I just go back to the point you made about ... Well, in my experience ...